

VILASRAO DESHMUKH

Minister of Heavy Industries and Public Enterprises

Heavy on Politics

His move from Mumbai to Delhi has been more talked about than his performance. Although he did battle for sops for the auto sector during the slowdown, he is yet to deliver on the much-promised reforms to empower the troubled PSUs.

Great Obsession

To return to Mumbai as chief minister of Maharashtra and redeem his image.



▼ 30%

MAMATA BANERJEE

Minister of Railways

Narrow Gauge

With her sights set on capturing West Bengal, she has little time for the Railways. Operating out of Kolkata rather than Delhi, she used the Budget to win her votes. Her sympathy for Maoists is an embarrassment for the Government.

Marquee Moment

She burst into tears at a Cabinet meeting before the Railway Budget when she was not allowed to include 24 new projects.



▼ 30%

FAROOQ ABDULLAH

Minister of New and Renewable Energy

Flash in the Pan

The flamboyant Abdullah has been handed one of the Government's new-age portfolios. Despite the fact that he threw a grand sulk when he was not part of the prime minister's first list of Cabinet appointees—rushing off to watch the IPL in South Africa as a mark of protest—he is yet to fulfil the mandate entrusted to him. One reason could be that his heart still lies in Jammu and Kashmir politics.

Achievements

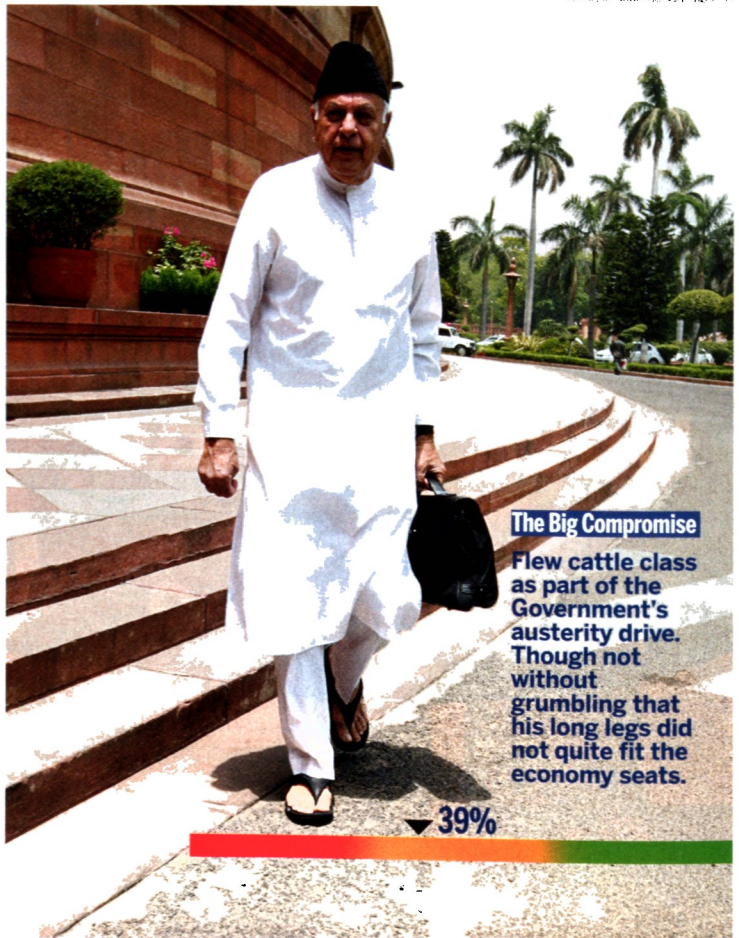
■ The announcement of the Jawaharlal Nehru National Solar Mission that has plans for 20,000 MW of solar energy by 2020.

■ Unlike other allies, Abdullah helps push through pro-reforms decisions in the Cabinet such as disinvestment.

Failures

■ The guidelines for grid solar projects are yet to be frozen by his ministry though these were to be announced in March 2010.

■ Import duties on solar equipment are yet to be finalised, leaving India with very few options in terms of technology.



The Big Compromise

Flew cattle class as part of the Government's austerity drive. Though not without grumbling that his long legs did not quite fit the economy seats.

▼ 39%